

# A Town Built on Lava: Fujiyoshida and the Pilgrims' Mountain

Fujiyoshida grew on lava flowing from Mount Fuji itself, its streets laid out by pilgrims' lodging-house keepers and its economy later rebuilt on silk. This dossier follows the town from the volcano's dated eruptions through the age of mass pilgrimage, a wartime memorial pagoda and 2013 World Heritage listing, to a 2026 decision about the crowds that listing brought.



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## In this dossier

1. A history of the district (6 chapters, about 1600 words)
2. Timeline
3. Walking notes
4. Then and now: aerial photographs
5. How the ground was made
6. Disasters remembered
7. Sources (11) and further reading

Written in English from Japanese library sources — chiefly books digitised by the National Diet Library — and official records. Superscript numbers point to the numbered sources at the end, with page frames for the digitised books.

## A town on the lava flows

Fujiyoshida sits directly on the northern apron of Mount Fuji, and its ground is, quite literally, the volcano's own recent history. Research published by Yamanashi Prefecture's Fuji World Heritage Center dates three of the lava flows beneath the modern city with some precision: an eruption of 800–802 sent lava toward what is now the Takamaruo area (a date the same research notes is contested, with some geologists preferring the twelfth or thirteenth century instead); an eruption of 864–866 produced the Aokigahara flow to the northwest; and an eruption the court chronicles date to 937 produced the first Kenmaruo flow, whose stony, thin-soiled surface underlies the district where Kamiyoshida's oldest pilgrim quarter would later stand. A city planning document lists eight villages — Kamigureji, Ko-Akemi, O-Akemi, Shimoyoshida, Arakura, Kamiyoshida, Matsuyama and Araya — that had taken shape at the foot of these flows by the Edo period, their farmers pushing new fields out onto the Kenmaruo and Hinokimaru-o lava plateaus as population grew. Kamiyoshida itself, the same document states plainly, was "born atop a maruo": a town raised on a lava ridge, not beside one.<sup>14</sup>

One product of that volcanic ground draws pilgrims of its own kind today. Where Fuji's Kenmaruo lava cooled around standing trees, the wood later burned or rotted away and left cave-like hollows in the rock; the largest surviving example, the Yoshida Tainai Jukei in upper Kamiyoshida, is both a nationally designated Natural Monument and one of the twenty-five constituent elements of Mount Fuji's UNESCO World Heritage listing. Local shrine keepers still lead an annual rite there each 29 April, the Tainai-sai, or "Womb Festival", named for the way pilgrims once crawled through the hollow as a symbolic rebirth before their ascent.<sup>1</sup>

## The shrine, the mountain and the pilgrim's lodge

Kitaguchi Hongu Fuji Sengen Shrine, at the head of Kamiyoshida's old main street, dates its own founding to a legend of the warrior-prince Yamato Takeru, who is said to have paused at a rise called Otsuka-yama during an eastern campaign traditionally placed in the reign of Emperor Keiko, gazed north at Fuji's slopes, and declared the mountain should be worshipped from that very spot; a torii was raised there, and the shrine's own history dates its formal founding, with a hall enshrining both Yamato Takeru and the mountain goddess Sengen-no-Okami, to the fiftieth year of the same reign. The shrine's own account continues into more verifiable history: after an eruption in 781, the provincial governor of Kai ordered divination, and in 788 a new hall was raised north of Otsuka-yama — the site the shrine still occupies — to which the mountain deity was moved, leaving Yamato Takeru enshrined at the older site.<sup>5</sup>

Ordinary pilgrims came much later than the legend, and in far greater numbers. A Fujiyoshida city planning document dates the widespread popular practice of climbing Mount Fuji for devotion to the second half of the fifteenth century, and it was from this period that the shrine's Great Torii and other facilities of worship, on the mountain and at its foot, began to be developed in earnest. The households that grew rich guiding and lodging these pilgrims were the oshi, literally something like "intermediary priests", and their long, narrow properties still line Kamiyoshida's old street, each with a private lane, called a tatsumichi, running back from the road toward the family's own shrine room. An early-twentieth-century climbers' guide to the Yoshida route already uses the route's modern name without explanation, describing the trail that starts from Kamiyoshida as the "Kitaguchi", the north gate, and noting where it meets the routes from Subashiri near the crater rim by Kusushi Shrine — evidence that the route names familiar today were already fixed well over a century ago. Thirty-eight of the old oshi buildings still stand in Kamiyoshida, the city's own survey records, though only two families continue the oshi trade itself; the rest of the old houses recall it through what visitors still eat: oshi cuisine, once served to lodged pilgrims and, by the city's account, built in the Edo period around dishes such as sliced raw carp.<sup>123</sup>

## Silk, noodles and a new kind of town

Long before pilgrimage became the town's main trade, the province was already known for cloth. Yamanashi's prefectural government traces the region's weaving back to the Engishiki, a legal code of 967 that records Kai province paying its tribute to the court in woven fabric, and credits later contact with foreign, "nanban", trade goods with helping the local silk called

kaiki develop its own reputation. It was in the Edo period that this cottage industry — begun, a Fujiyoshida city document notes, as off-season work to supplement farming — grew into the fine, lightweight weave known across Japan as Gunnai orimono, and by the Taisho and early Showa periods kaiki had become a fashionable lining fabric nationwide; production peaked, the prefecture's own account says, in the Meiji era, and the Fujiyoshida Textile Cooperative, founded in 1951, still organizes weavers whose product today makes up some four in ten of Japan's domestically made necktie fabrics.<sup>18</sup>

The mill town fed itself on its own invention. In the early Showa years, the city's cultural-heritage survey records, noodle shops in Kamiyoshida's Kinuya-cho — "Silk House Town" — began serving a thick, chewy wheat noodle to visiting textile wholesalers and workers from the surrounding villages; that dish, Yoshida udon, is still the everyday food most associated with the city. Formal city status followed the textile boom rather than preceding it: Fujiyoshida was created on 20 March 1951 by the merger of the towns of Fuji-Kamiyoshida, Shimoyoshida and Akemi, gained the Kamiigure district in a further 1960 boundary change, and today, at 121.74 square kilometres, is unusual among Japanese cities in that most of its area — the Kamiyoshida district alone covers over 90 square kilometres — consists of the slope of Mount Fuji itself, reaching the summit within city limits.<sup>110</sup>

## A pagoda for the war dead

The five-storey tower that now draws visitors above Kamiyoshida was not built as a viewpoint. In August 1958 the city formed a memorial-construction committee under the mayor; ground was broken in April 1959, and after three years of work the tower, modelled on the five-storey pagoda of Shitennoji temple in Osaka and built of steel-plate-roofed reinforced concrete, was completed in April 1962. Rising 19.5 metres — a 13-metre body under a 6.5-metre spire, on a base 7.3 metres square — it holds the memorial tablets of 1,055 people from Fujiyoshida killed in the First Sino-Japanese War, the Russo-Japanese War, the First World War and the Pacific War, raised at a cost of some 9.37 million yen funded substantially by public donation.<sup>9</sup>

The pagoda stands within Arakurayama Sengen Park, reached from the Arakura Fuji Sengen Shrine below by a 398-step flight known as the Sakuya-hime stairway, about 200 metres long; the observation deck beside the pagoda, which frames Fuji and the tower together in the composition now familiar worldwide, was rebuilt and reopened in February 2022.<sup>11</sup>

## World Heritage and the four sites in town

On 22 June 2013 UNESCO's World Heritage Committee inscribed "Fujisan — Sacred Place and Source of Artistic Inspiration" as Japan's seventeenth World Heritage property, a cultural rather than natural listing built around Mount Fuji's role in belief and art rather than its geology alone. Of the twenty-five separate elements that make up the property, four lie within Fujiyoshida: the mountain itself, so far as it falls in the city; and, in Kamiyoshida, two individual oshi houses kept as historic residences, the former Togawa house and the Osano house, together with the Yoshida Tainai Jukei lava-tree cave described earlier in this dossier. The pairing of an intact pilgrim lodging house with a natural lava feature in the same small listing is itself a statement about how the shrine, the mountain and the volcano's own rock were always treated as a single object of devotion.<sup>16</sup>

## Reading the ground today, and its limits

Kamiyoshida's old main street still rewards slow walking: the long, narrow oshi plots, the private tatsumichi lanes running back toward household shrine rooms, and the Great Torii closing the view toward the mountain are all still legible, even where a given building has been rebuilt. The lava ridge the town stands on is harder to see directly, but the abrupt, stony rises around the Yoshida Tainai cave and the Kenmaruo district are the same 937 flow the World Heritage Center's own research has dated; comparing them with the smoother, older ground toward Shimoyoshida is one way to feel the different lava flows this dossier's geology has described. The textile trade has left its own reminders in street names such as Kinuya-cho, in the sound of shuttle looms still audible from a handful of working mills, and in the everyday habit of a bowl of Yoshida udon rather than any single surviving factory building.<sup>14</sup>

Success has brought its own problem. On 3 February 2026 Fujiyoshida's city government announced it would not hold its usual spring cherry-blossom festival at Arakurayama Sengen Park — an event that had drawn some 200,000 visitors over its run and more than 10,000 in a single day at its peak — citing overtourism that the city said had begun to include visitors trespassing onto residents' private property, littering, and crowding pavements in ways that endangered local children. The city said it would still post security staff, manage traffic and provide temporary parking and toilets through the expected bloom period in early April, even without a formal festival, with the mayor framing the decision as putting "the life and dignity of citizens" ahead of tourism promotion — an explicit attempt, after little more than a decade as a World Heritage backdrop, to choose a slower, more sustainable relationship with the crowds the pagoda's silhouette now attracts worldwide.<sup>7</sup>

## Timeline

|                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>800-802</b>                            | An eruption sends lava toward what becomes the Takamaruo area (a date some geologists place instead in the 12th-13th century). <sup>4</sup>                                          |
| <b>864-866</b>                            | An eruption produces the Aokigahara lava flow northwest of the later town. <sup>4</sup>                                                                                              |
| <b>937</b>                                | An eruption produces the first Kenmaruo lava flow, the ground under Kamiyoshida's pilgrim quarter and the Yoshida Tainai cave. <sup>4</sup>                                          |
| <b>967</b>                                | The Engishiki legal code records Kai province paying tribute to the court in woven cloth, the region's earliest documented textile trade. <sup>8</sup>                               |
| <b>traditional, Emperor Keiko's reign</b> | Kitaguchi Hongu Fuji Sengen Shrine dates its founding legend (Yamato Takeru's visit to Otsuka-yama) to this era; the shrine's own account treats the date as tradition. <sup>5</sup> |
| <b>781 / 788</b>                          | Following an eruption in 781, the shrine's main hall is rebuilt in 788 on its present site north of Otsuka-yama. <sup>5</sup>                                                        |
| <b>late 15th century</b>                  | Popular pilgrimage-climbing of Mount Fuji becomes widespread; the Great Torii and other worship facilities at Kitaguchi Hongu develop from this period. <sup>1</sup>                 |
| <b>1895 / 1921</b>                        | Published climbers' guides to the Yoshida route already use the modern trail names (Kitaguchi) and describe Kamiyoshida's pilgrim infrastructure. <sup>23</sup>                      |
| <b>20 March 1951</b>                      | Fujiyoshida City is created by the merger of Fuji-Kamiyoshida, Shimoyoshida and Akemi towns. <sup>10</sup>                                                                           |
| <b>1951</b>                               | The Fujiyoshida Textile Cooperative is founded, organizing the town's Gunnai-orimono/kaiki weaving industry. <sup>1</sup>                                                            |
| <b>1958-1962</b>                          | The Chureito memorial pagoda is planned (1958), built (from 1959) and completed (April 1962), commemorating 1,055 Fujiyoshida war dead. <sup>9</sup>                                 |
| <b>1960</b>                               | The Kamiigure district is annexed to Fujiyoshida City. <sup>10</sup>                                                                                                                 |
| <b>22 June 2013</b>                       | UNESCO inscribes "Fujisan" as a World Heritage cultural property; four constituent elements lie within Fujiyoshida. <sup>16</sup>                                                    |
| <b>February 2022</b>                      | The observation deck beside the Chureito pagoda reopens after renovation. <sup>11</sup>                                                                                              |
| <b>3 February 2026</b>                    | Fujiyoshida City announces it will not hold the Arakurayama Sengen Park cherry-blossom festival, citing overtourism. <sup>7</sup>                                                    |

## Walking notes

Places to stand and look, in walking order. Straight-line distances only; check today's access and opening before you go.

- 1 Kitaguchi Hongu Fuji Sengen Shrine and the Great Torii** 北口本宮富士浅間神社. The shrine that has anchored Kamiyoshida's pilgrim town since its 788 rebuilding; the Great Torii before the approach frames the start of the old Yoshida climbing route, and several shrine buildings are designated Important Cultural Properties.<sup>15</sup>
- 2 Kamiyoshida's old oshi street and tatsumichi lanes** 上吉田の御師町・タツ道. Long, narrow former pilgrim-lodge properties line the old main street; look for the private tatsumichi lanes running back from the road to each house's own shrine room, and signboards explaining individual oshi houses.<sup>1</sup>
- 3 Yoshida Tainai Jukei** 吉田胎内樹型. A lava-tree-mold cave formed by the 937 Kenmaruo flow, a nationally designated Natural Monument and one of the four Fujiyoshida elements of the Mount Fuji World Heritage listing; the site of the annual Tainai-sai rite each 29 April.<sup>14</sup>
- 4 Arakurayama Sengen Park and the Chureito pagoda** 新倉山浅間公園・忠霊塔. Climb the 398-step Sakuya-hime stairway from Arakura Fuji Sengen Shrine to the 1962 war-memorial pagoda and its 2022-renovated observation deck,

framing Mount Fuji and the tower together.<sup>911</sup>

- 5 **Kinuya-cho and a bowl of Yoshida udon** 絹屋町・吉田うどん. The old "Silk House Town" where noodle shops began serving thick Yoshida udon to textile wholesalers in the early Showa years; several shops in the area continue the tradition.<sup>1</sup>

## The same ground, 1974–1978 and 2020



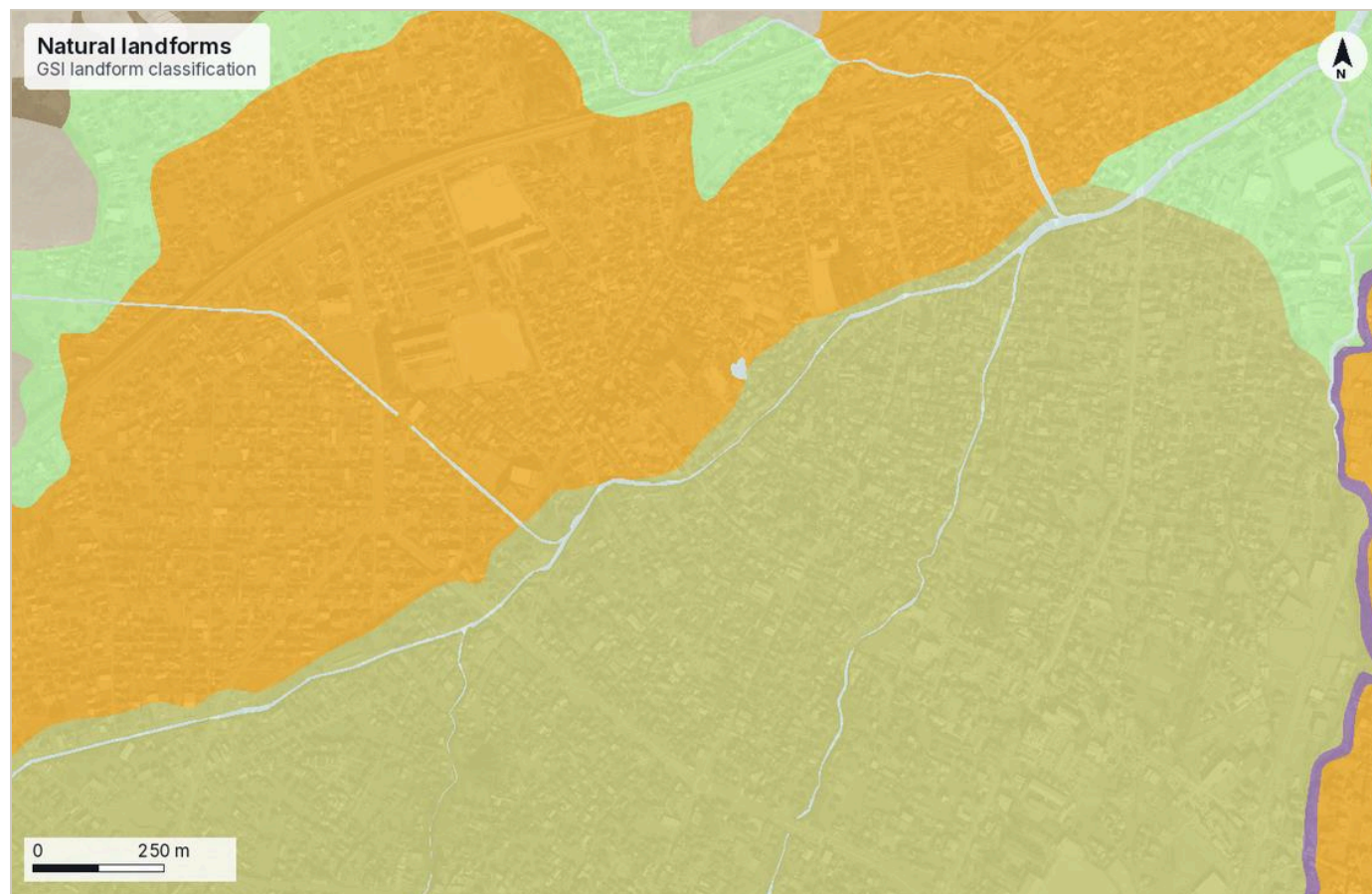
1974–1978 aerial photograph — GSI Tiles *gazo1*, cropped and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. North is up; the frame is identical in both images.



2020 annual orthophoto — GSI Tiles *nendophoto2020*, cropped and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. Capture dates within a mosaic can differ from place to place.

**How to compare.** Anchor on features that rarely move — river banks, rail lines, shrine and temple grounds, main roads — then look for what changed around them. Differences in tone come from film, camera and season, not from the land itself.

## Rivers, shorelines and terraces



Natural landforms as classified by GSI, over a recent aerial photograph in gray. Dark blue outlines mark former river channels.

|                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <span style="display: inline-block; width: 15px; height: 15px; background-color: yellow; border: 1px solid black;"></span> Alluvial fan 48%                     | <span style="display: inline-block; width: 15px; height: 15px; background-color: orange; border: 1px solid black;"></span> Plateaus and terraces 38%         |
| <span style="display: inline-block; width: 15px; height: 15px; background-color: lightgreen; border: 1px solid black;"></span> Floodplain and coastal plain 10% | <span style="display: inline-block; width: 15px; height: 15px; background-color: lightbrown; border: 1px solid black;"></span> Mountain and hill slopes 1.6% |
| <span style="display: inline-block; width: 15px; height: 15px; background-color: lightblue; border: 1px solid black;"></span> Water 1.3%                        | <span style="display: inline-block; width: 15px; height: 15px; background-color: brown; border: 1px solid black;"></span> Foothill deposits 0.8%             |
| <span style="display: inline-block; width: 15px; height: 15px; background-color: purple; border: 1px solid black;"></span> Cliffs and terrace scarps 0.6%       |                                                                                                                                                              |

### What the main landforms mean

**Alluvial fan (48%).** Gently sloping ground spreading fan-like from a valley mouth, built from sediment dropped by floods. Floodwater from the mountains, and debris flows near the valley mouth. Relatively firm ground; a slight liquefaction tendency on the lower fan.

**Plateaus and terraces (38%).** Flat ground standing in steps above its surroundings, left behind as the land around it was eroded. River flooding is rarely a threat unless the terrace is only slightly above the river; watch the slopes at its edges. Firm ground: shaking is relatively weak and liquefaction is unlikely.

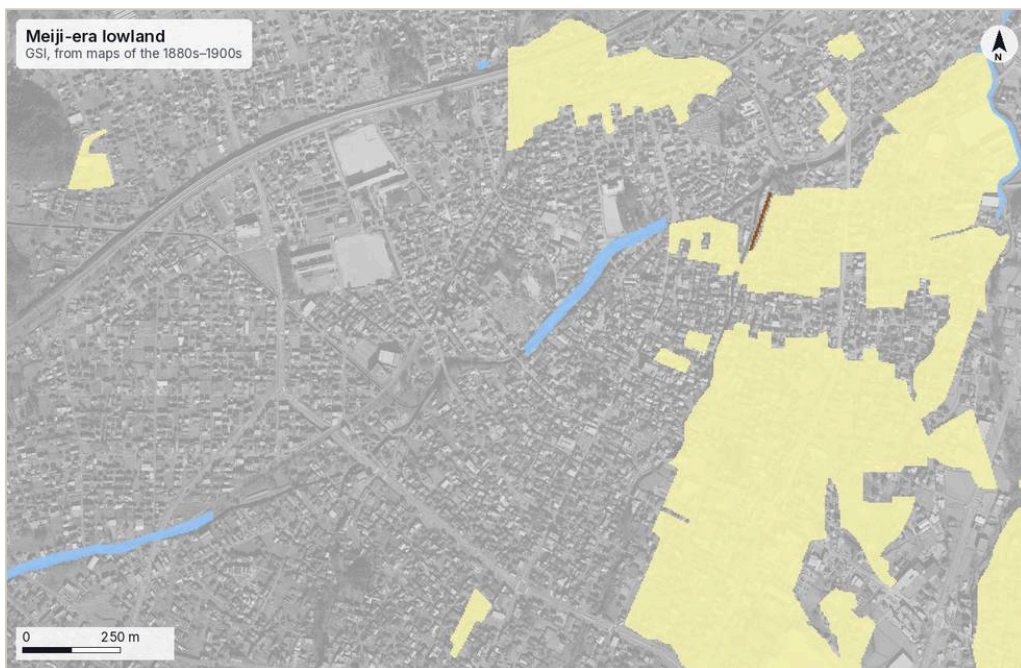
**Floodplain and coastal plain (10%).** Low, flat ground of little relief, built from sand and mud left by floods, or former seabed that emerged. River flooding. Ground is softer nearer the coast and shakes somewhat more; liquefaction tendency is strong on coastal plains and somewhat strong on floodplains. Storm surge near the coast.

Descriptions translated and condensed from GSI's landform-classification legend. They describe tendencies of each landform type, not the condition of any individual plot.

## Fill, reclamation and the fields beneath the town



Hatching: man-made ground as classified by GSI. Teal outlines: former sea, river or pond. Dark blue outlines: former river channels.



GSI “Meiji-era lowland” data, traced from topographic maps of the 1880s–1900s; GSI warns that positions can be off by a considerable distance, especially in the Kanto and Kinki regions. Only low, wet or open ground was traced: towns, dry fields and forest of the period are left blank.

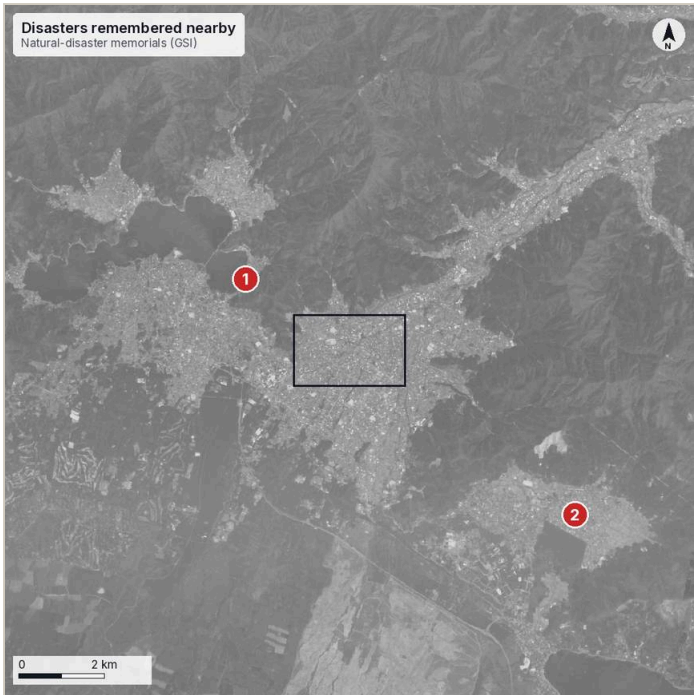
### Man-made ground

-  Cut ground 1.7%
-  Filled and reclaimed land 1.5%

### Meiji-era lowland

-  Rice paddy 20%
-  River, pond or sea 0.7%

# Memorials to natural disasters nearby



Numbered memorials; the black rectangle is the study area of this brief. Frame 16 km across.

Fewer than three memorials stand within 3 km of the study area, so the nearest ones within 8 km are listed.

| Memorial                                                                           | Disaster                                                                                                                           | Erected | Distance |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|----------|
| 1 Monument of the Lake Kawaguchi Flood Control Association 河口湖治水組合記念碑              | High water on Lake Kawaguchi (Aug 1983) and the Fuji Five Lakes (9–12 Sep 1991) · other                                            | 2002    | 2.9 km   |
| 2 Memorial to the 1923 Great Kanto Earthquake and the floods that followed 大震水災記念碑 | Great Kanto Earthquake (1 Sep 1923) and the heavy rain that followed (14 Sep 1923) · flood / landslide or debris flow / earthquake | 1924    | 6.5 km   |

## What the memorials record

1. **Monument of the Lake Kawaguchi Flood Control Association.** Lake Kawaguchi has no outflowing river, so rising water has long threatened lakeside life. After heavy rain from Typhoon No. 5 in August 1983 the lake kept rising for about a week, flooding hotels and homes near the shore (68 houses above floor level). In September 1991 heavy rain raised the Fuji Five Lakes, submerging lakeside roads and flooding 13 houses.
2. **Memorial to the 1923 Great Kanto Earthquake and the floods that followed.** The earthquake of 1 September 1923 brought down 72 shrines, temples and houses in Uchino, cracked roads and fields and sent muddy water gushing up; aftershocks were frequent. Heavy rain from the night of 13 September then caused landslides and floods that left trees and stones piled about 2 m deep, ruined the fields and flooded 291 houses.

Source: GSI Natural Disaster Memorials (自然災害伝承碑). English names and notes are Japan Time Atlas translations and summaries of GSI's Japanese descriptions; the memorials' own inscriptions may say more. "Erected" is the year GSI records for the monument.

## Sources

1. 富士吉田市 (Fujiyoshida City), 富士吉田市文化財保存活用地域計画 [Fujiyoshida City regional plan for the preservation and use of cultural properties], 2019; NDL frames 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 9. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/12360078/1/1> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: The eight Edo-period foot-of-mountain villages and their expansion onto lava plateaus; Kamiyoshida "born atop a maruo"; the Yoshida Tainai lava-tree cave and its rituals; oshi houses, tatsumichi lanes and oshi cuisine; the Gunnai/kaiki textile industry and Yoshida udon; the Yoshida Fire Festival; the four Fujiyoshida elements of the Mount Fuji World Heritage listing. Read as OCR snippets via the NDL full-text search API (control characters in the raw response required stripping before parsing).
2. 渡辺清孝 (Watanabe Kiyotaka), 富士登山吉田口案内 [Guide to the Yoshida route up Mount Fuji], 1921; NDL frames 8, 9, 28. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/964967/1/28> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: Kamiyoshida's contemporary administrative label; a May 1921 memorial stone raised atop Suwa-mori by local volunteers; a prefectural forestry project improving the pilgrim trail toward Umagaeshi. Read as OCR snippets via the NDL full-text search API.
3. 望岳楼主人 (喜多山正誼) (Kitayama Masayoshi, pen name Bogakuro-shujin), 富士登山案内 [Guide to climbing Mount Fuji], 1895; NDL frame 8. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/765294/1/8> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: Confirms the "Kitaguchi" (north gate) name for the Kamiyoshida route was already standard usage by 1895, meeting the Subashiri route near the crater by Kusushi Shrine. Read as an OCR snippet via the NDL full-text search API.
4. 世界遺産富士山：山梨県立富士山世界遺産センター研究紀要 [World Heritage Fujisan: research bulletin of the Yamanashi Prefectural Fuji World Heritage Center], 山梨県立富士山世界遺産センター (Yamanashi Prefectural Fuji World Heritage Center), 2018; NDL frame 0. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/11477924/1/0> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: Dated eruption/lava-flow chronology: the 800-802 Takamaruo-area flow (with a competing 12th-13th century dating noted), the 864-866 Aokigahara flow, and the 937 first Kenmaruo flow underlying Kamiyoshida's pilgrim quarter. Read as OCR snippets via the NDL full-text search API.
5. 由緒 [Founding history], 北口本宮富士浅間神社 (Kitaguchi Hongu Fuji Sengen Shrine). <https://www.sengenjinja.jp/yuisho/index.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The Yamato Takeru/Otsuka-yama founding legend, the shrine's traditional founding in Emperor Keiko's 50th year, the 781 eruption and divination, and the 788 rebuilding of the main hall on its present site.
6. 世界遺産について [About the World Heritage listing], 山梨県立富士山世界遺産センター (Yamanashi Prefectural Fuji World Heritage Center). <https://www.fujisan-whc.jp/about/heritage.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 2013 inscription and official registered name of the Mount Fuji World Heritage property (a cultural, not natural, listing).
7. 新倉山浅間公園桜まつりを開催しないことに決定 [Decision not to hold the Arakurayama Sengen Park cherry-blossom festival], 富士吉田市 (Fujiyoshida City), distributed via PR TIMES, 2026. <https://prtimes.jp/main/html/rd/p/000000032.000126597.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 3 February 2026 announcement, visitor numbers (about 200,000 over the festival period, 10,000+ on peak days), the specific overtourism problems cited, and the safety measures the city said would continue without a formal festival.
8. 美しき伝統織物「甲斐絹」 [The beautiful traditional textile "kaiki"], 山梨県 (Yamanashi Prefecture). <https://www.pref.yamanashi.jp/miryoku/waza/orimono/index.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 967 Engishiki reference to Kai province's cloth tribute, the role of nanban-trade silk in kaiki's development, the Edo-period boom and Meiji-era production peak, and the fabric's present-day use in neckties.
9. 富士吉田市戦没者慰霊塔 (新倉山浅間公園・忠霊塔) [Fujiyoshida City's war memorial (Arakurayama Sengen Park, Chureito)], 戦跡紀行ネット (Senseki Kikou, a war-sites research site). <https://senseki-kikou.net/?amp=1&p=58041>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The pagoda's 1958-1962 construction history, its Shitennoji-derived design, dimensions, cost, and the 1,055 Fujiyoshida war dead it commemorates.
10. 市のあらまし [Outline of the city], 富士吉田市 (Fujiyoshida City). <https://www.city.fujiyoshida.yamanashi.jp/page/1520.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 1951 merger that created Fujiyoshida City, the 1960 annexation of Kamiigure, and the present-day area of the city and its four districts.
11. 新倉山浅間公園 [Arakurayama Sengen Park], 富士の国やまなし観光ネット (Yamanashi Prefecture official tourism site). [https://www.yamanashi-kankou.jp/kankou/spot/p1\\_4919.html](https://www.yamanashi-kankou.jp/kankou/spot/p1_4919.html), checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 398-step Sakuya-hime stairway and its length, and the February 2022 renovation and reopening of the observation deck beside the Chureito pagoda.

## Further reading

- 上吉田の民俗：富士吉田市上吉田 (富士吉田市教育委員会市史編さん室編, 1989) — A dedicated folklore survey of Kamiyoshida, with far more detail on individual oshi households and customs than could be verified here. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/13229711> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- 富士吉田市史 民俗編 第1巻 (富士吉田市史編さん委員会編, 1996) — The city's own folklore-volume history, covering the Fire Festival, oshi culture and Fuji-ko pilgrimage confraternities in depth. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/13230048> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- 富士吉田の文化財 その16 (富士山御師) (富士吉田市文化財審議会編, 1981) — A dedicated booklet on the oshi of Mount Fuji, useful for verifying individual oshi house histories. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/12419455> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- 富士山御師 (伊藤堅吉著, 1968) — An early scholarly monograph on the oshi institution across the Fuji region. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/3449462> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- 富士浅間信仰 (平野栄次編, 1987) — An academic collection on Sengen/Fuji faith, relevant to the shrine's founding traditions and the Fuji-ko movement; NDL premises only. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/12266463> (NDL premises only)

- **富士吉田市史資料叢書 11 (富士吉田市史編さん室編, 1991)** — Primary documentary sources for the city's history, including early-modern village records. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/13229694> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))

## Where a Deep Research request would go next

- **Individual oshi household registers, guest ledgers (道者帳) and the boundaries of each oshi's traditional pilgrim clientele (danna-ba)** — 富士吉田市歴史民俗博物館 (Fujiyoshida City Museum of Local History) and the city's 市史編さん室 (History Compilation Office). Contact the museum directly; many oshi families' surviving document collections are catalogued there rather than digitised.
- **Precise dating and extent of the Takamaruo, Kenmaruo and Hinokimaru-o lava flows beneath the city** — 山梨県立富士山世界遺産センター (Yamanashi Prefectural Fuji World Heritage Center) and the Geological Survey of Japan (AIST). Consult the Center's published research bulletins and geological maps directly; the 2018 bulletin used here notes some datings remain debated among specialists.
- **Wartime and immediate postwar aerial photography of Fujiyoshida, predating the GSI series used in this dossier's companion Basic brief** — US National Archives (NARA), College Park, Maryland. Search the NARA catalog for wartime reconnaissance imagery of the Fuji-Yoshida area; reproductions can be ordered remotely.
- **Municipal planning and negotiation records behind the 2026 decision not to hold the cherry-blossom festival, and any follow-up visitor-management policy** — 富士吉田市 観光課 (Fujiyoshida City Tourism Division). Request the city's own policy papers and visitor-count data directly; the press release used here summarises but does not itself contain the underlying study.
- **Household-level records of the Gunnai/kaiki textile trade's rise and its Showa-era decline** — はたおりまち文化館 (Hataori Machi Bunkakan, the city's textile-history museum) and 富士吉田織物協同組合 (Fujiyoshida Textile Cooperative). Visit or contact the museum and cooperative directly for mill records and oral histories not covered in the general prefectural account used here.

## Caveats

- The dating of the pre-Kenmaruo (Takamaruo-area) lava flow is contested even within the source used here (800-802 versus a possible 12th-13th century), and is reported with that uncertainty.
- Kitaguchi Hongu Fuji Sengen Shrine's founding date (Emperor Keiko's reign, traditionally around the 2nd century CE) is the shrine's own tradition and is presented as such, not as an independently verified historical fact.
- A 1921 guidebook labels Kamiyoshida as part of "Mizuho village"; other evidence suggests the successor-town lineage from Mizuho-mura ran instead through Shimoyoshida, and this dossier could not resolve the discrepancy from sources read in this session, so only the 1921 book's own contemporary label is used.
- Visitor and crowding figures for the 2026 cherry-blossom festival decision are those given in the city's own press release; no independent visitor count was checked in this session.

Digitised books are cited, not reproduced: the page frames let you open the same page in the NDL Digital Collections. Aerial photographs, landform and memorial data: GSI, processed by Japan Time Atlas. This experimental edition is a draft for testing the product and has not had independent fact-checking.